

If you don't have an HSA through work, you can get your own HSA and 100% of what you put in there, depending on family or self-coverage limits, will be tax deductible. So for us, we have an HSA through Chase Credit Union and the max contribution for the year is \$6,500. We then pay our medical expenses out of that account.

–Katie, UT

3. SEPARATE AND SAVE

While Joseph and I are on the same insurance plan now, it hasn't always been that way. He had insurance through a previous job, and although it wasn't the best plan ever, the price made it a no-brainer to participate. However, the cost would have more than tripled to add me to the policy!

We decided that the best course of action would be to put me on an entirely separate plan, and although I paid a pretty penny every month, it was much less than if we had doubled up on the same plan. This doesn't *always* happen, but it's enough to at least make a little research on the front end worth doing.

Experiment with a split policy among family members, then compare the final totals to see if you can score a cheaper rate. If you have children, see what it would cost for them to be a dependent under one spouse, separated under both, or on a government plan of their own. The results may surprise you!

4. PARTICIPATE IN WELLNESS INCENTIVES

Many health plans offer incentives for staying healthy, and will actually reward you for getting yearly checkups, or logging your exercise every day. When I worked as a bank teller, my health insurance gave us the chance to participate in quarterly challenges, and we could win gift cards or cash just for completing each task.